ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 23

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Maithili Alphabet

हमर पहिल मैथिली वर्णमाला

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 51 Maithili Letters with English Phonetics

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Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

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My First Maithili Alphabet — हमर पहिल मैथिली वर्णमाला
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 23

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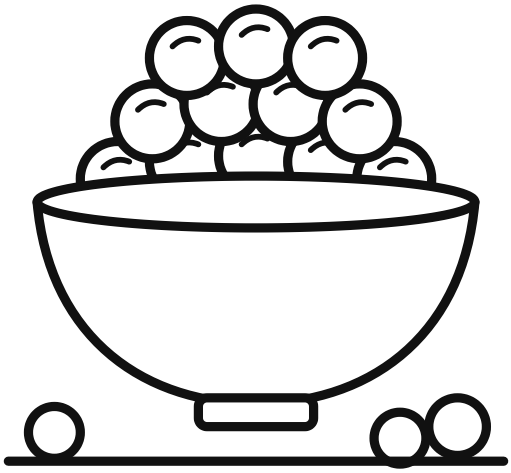
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Illustrations: line art created with AI assistance and reviewed by the author. In keeping with the publisher's guidelines, the pictures show objects, plants and nature only — no people or animals.

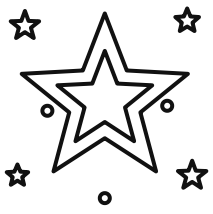
Fonts: Baloo 2, Noto Sans Devanagari, Fredoka, Nunito, Amiri and Dancing Script, all under the SIL Open Font License. **Map data:** Natural Earth (public domain).

A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.

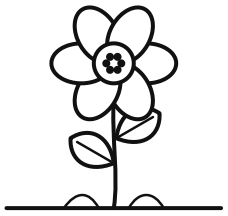


This book belongs to
ई पोथी हमर अछि

I started learning Maithili on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 23 is Maithili. More languages of the subcontinent are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- **Doubled vowels are long:** *aa* as in "father", *ee* as in "see", *oo* as in "moon".
- **h after a letter** (*kh, gh, th, dh, bh*) means "add a puff of breath" — hold a tissue in front of your mouth and watch it move! It never means the English "th" of "the".
- **a** is the short sound in "about". Every consonant carries it: क = *ka*; at the end of a word it is usually silent.
- **A dot under t, d, n** (*ṭ, ḍ, ṇ*) means a *hard* sound with the tongue curled back; *ṛ* is a quick flap of the tongue.

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Maithili name** written in Maithili (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *Maithili phonetics* shows how the sound is built the way Maithili children learn it, for example क् + अ = क, or a vowel sign added to a consonant.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow standard Maithili as spoken around Darbhanga and Madhubani.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Maithili! मैथिली

maithilee — the Maithili word for the language

Who speaks it?
About **14 million people** in India and more than **3 million** in Nepal speak Maithili.[3]

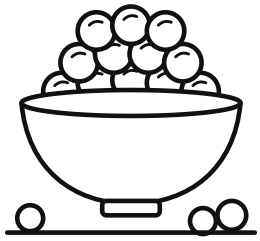
Where?
In **Mithila**: the plains of north **Bihar** in India (Darbhanga, Madhubani) and the eastern lowlands of **Nepal** (Janakpur). It is the second most spoken language of Nepal.

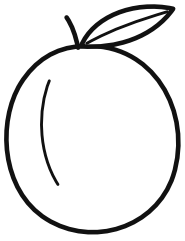
How is it written?
Today in **Devanagari**, from **left to right**. Long ago it had its own script, **Tirhuta** (*Mithilakshar*), a cousin of the Bengali script.

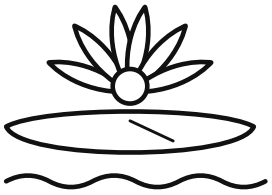
How many letters?
This book teaches **51**: **13 vowels** (स्वर) and **38 consonants** (व्यंजन), including ड़ ढ़ and क्ष त्र ज्ञ.

Rare letters
ऋ अः ङ ञ ण ष क्ष ज्ञ live mostly in words from Sanskrit. The pages for them say so.

Did you know?
Mithila is famous for मखान *makhaan*, the puffed seeds of a water plant, for its many ponds, and for colourful wall paintings. In **2003** Maithili became one of India's official languages.[3]







THE WHOLE ALPHABET

The Maithili Alphabet वर्णमाला

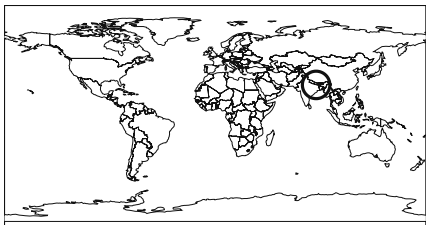
13 vowels — स्वर

अ *a*	आ *aa*	इ *i*	ई *ee*	उ *u*	ऊ *oo*	ऋ *ri*
ए *e*	ऐ *ai*	ओ *o*	औ *au*	अं *an*	अः *ah*	

38 consonants — व्यंजन

क *ka*	ख *kha*	ग *ga*	घ *gha*	ङ *nga*	च *cha*	छ *chha*
ज *ja*	झ *jha*	ञ *nya*	ट *ṭa*	ठ *ṭha*	ड *ḍa*	ढ *ḍha*
ण *ṇa*	त *ta*	थ *tha*	द *da*	ध *dha*	न *na*	प *pa*
फ *pha*	ब *ba*	भ *bha*	म *ma*	य *ya*	र *ra*	ल *la*
व *va*	श *sha*	ष *sha*	स *sa*	ह *ha*	ड़ *ṛa*	ढ़ *ṛha*
क्ष *ksha*	त्र *tra*	ज्ञ *gya*				

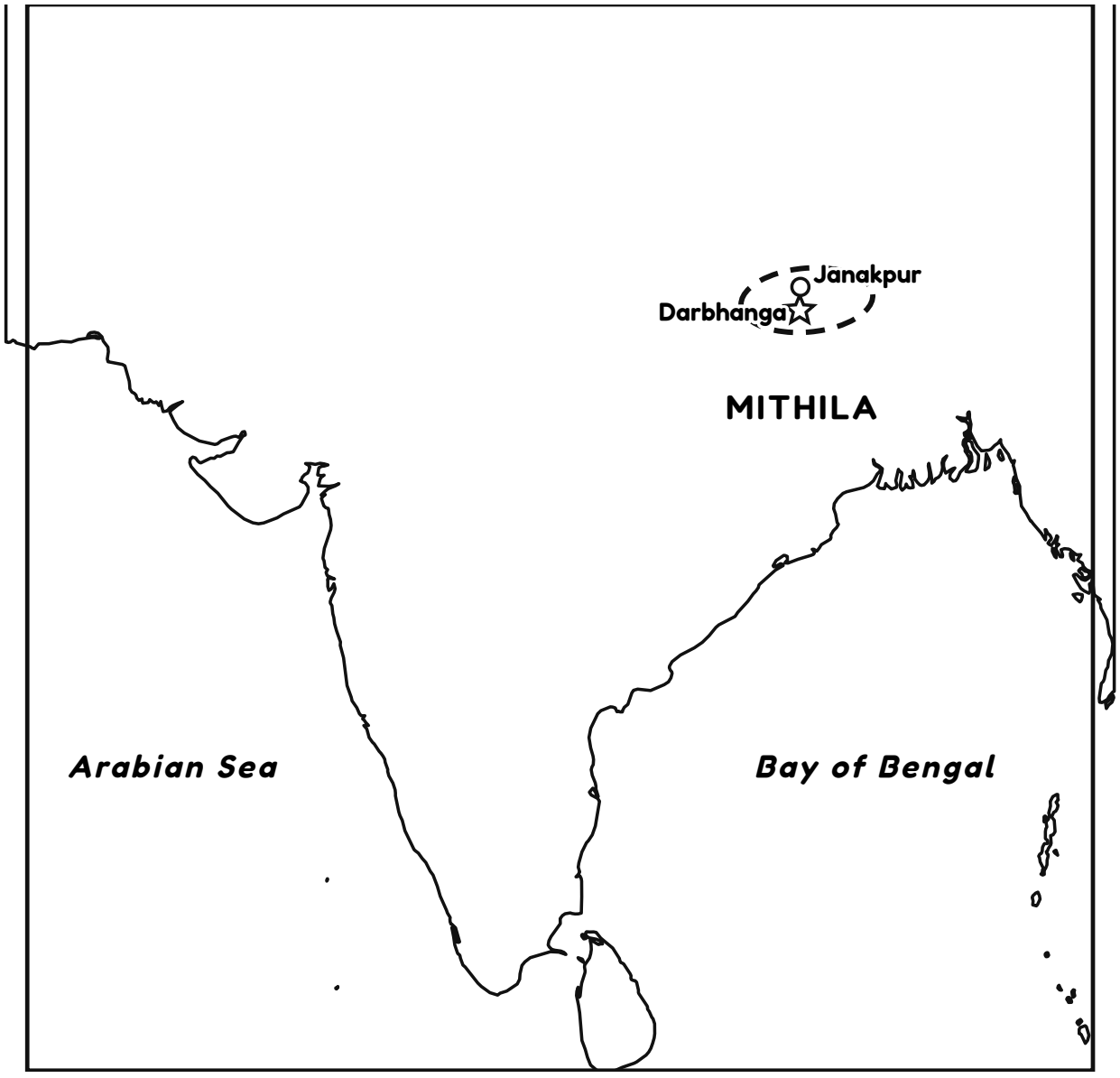
Read the alphabet left to right, row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows Mithila on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Maithili spoken?



Color it: Mithila (inside the dashed line) **yellow** · the rest of the land **green** · the seas **blue**. Draw little blue ponds inside it! **Find it:** Darbhanga ★ is the biggest Maithili city in Bihar; Janakpur is the biggest Maithili city in Nepal.

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PART 1

The Vowels स्वर

svar — "voice letters"

Vowels are the sounds you make with your mouth open: *a*, *aa*, *i*, *ee*, *u*, *oo*... This book has **13 vowels**.

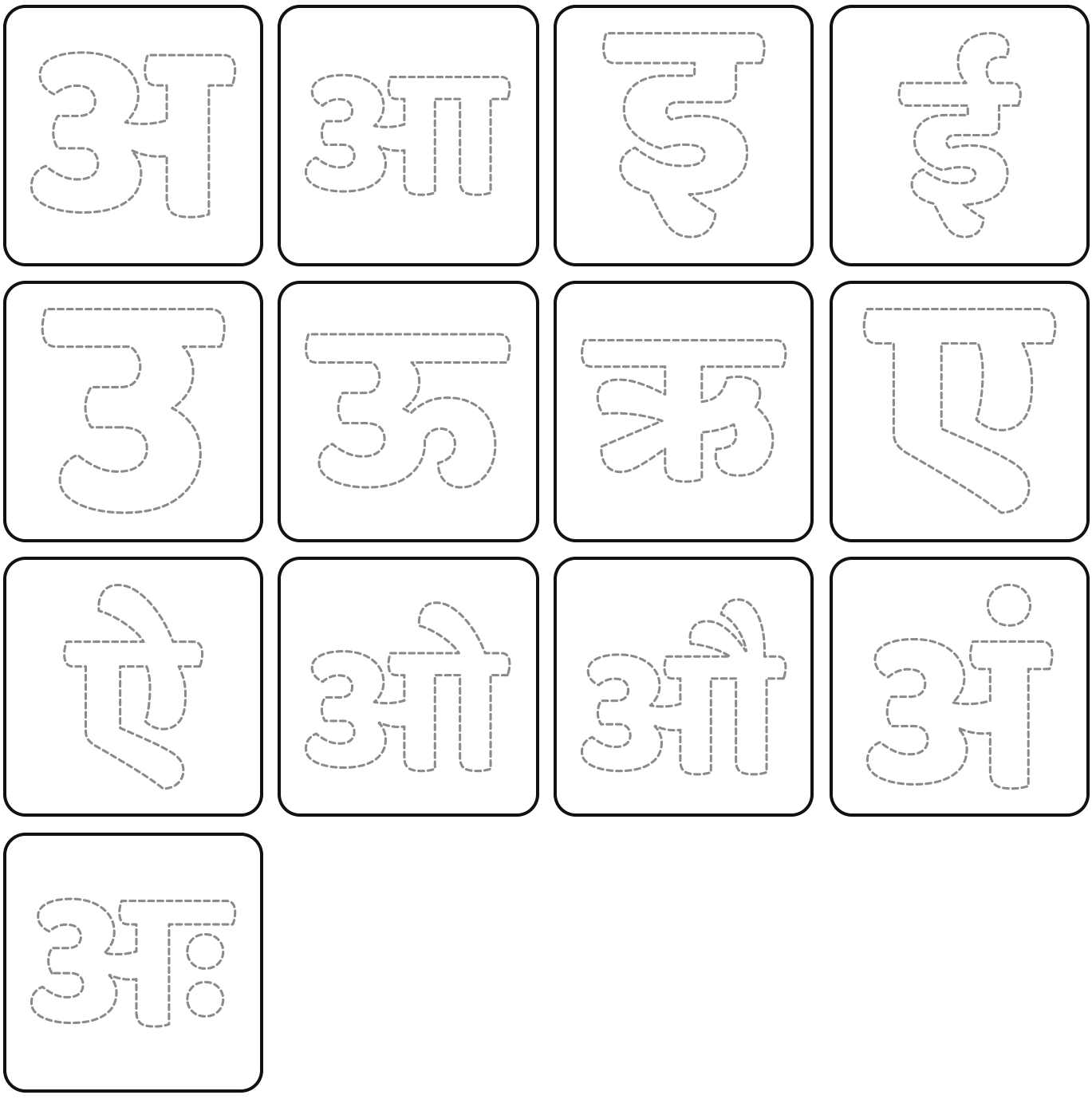
A vowel has **two shapes**. At the start of a word it is a full letter. After a consonant it becomes a small **vowel sign** that holds on to the consonant: क + ा = का. **Rare in Maithili:** ऋ and अः appear only in a few words that come from Sanskrit.

Vowel	Name	Sign	With क
अ	*a*	—	क
आ	*aa*	ा	का
इ	*i*	ि	कि
ई	*ee*	ी	की
उ	*u*	ु	कु
ऊ	*oo*	ू	कू
ऋ	*ri*	ृ	कृ
ए	*e*	े	के
ऐ	*ai*	ै	कै
ओ	*o*	ो	को
औ	*au*	ौ	कौ
अं	*an*	ं	कं
अः	*ah*	ः	कः

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the vowels स्वर

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



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NAME · नाम

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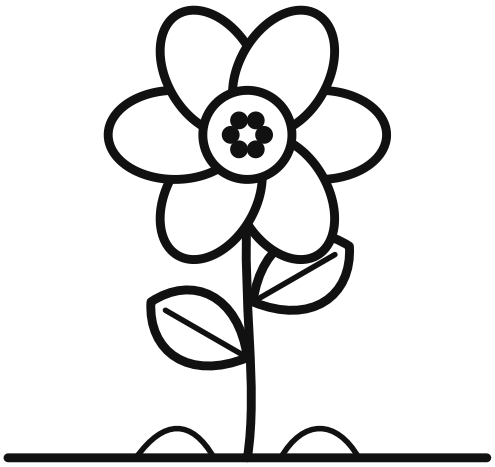
a

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a short ‘a’ as in “about”

MAITHILI PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

No sign! अ hides inside every consonant: क = क् + अ



अ IS FOR

अड़हुल

aṛahul

hibiscus flower

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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NAME · नाम

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aa

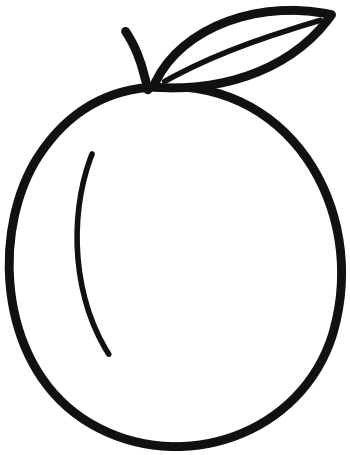
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'aa' as in "father"

MAITHILI PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ा (आकार)

क + ा = का



आ IS FOR

आम

aam

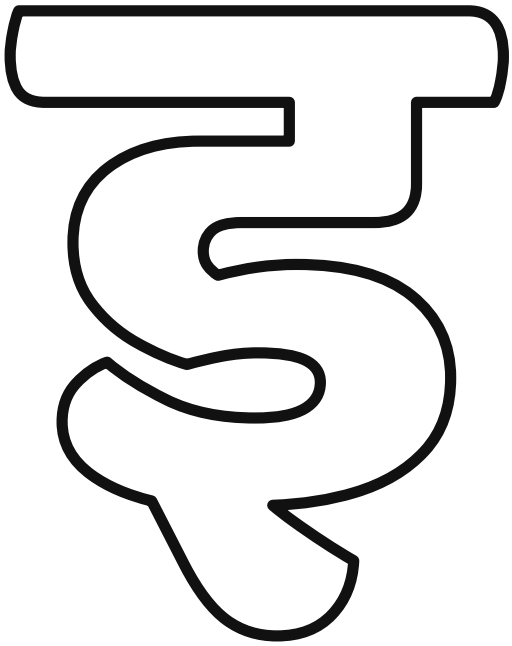
mango

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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NAME · नाम

इ

i

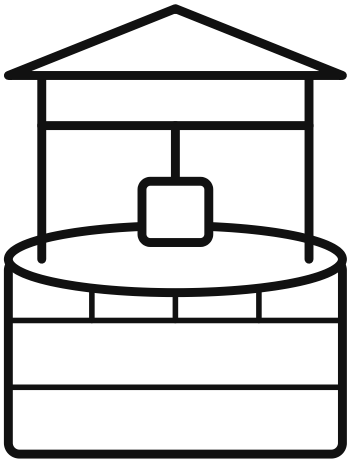
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'i' as in "sit" — short

MAITHILI PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ि (इकार)

क + ि = कि



इ IS FOR

इनार

inaar

well (for water)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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NAME · नाम

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ee

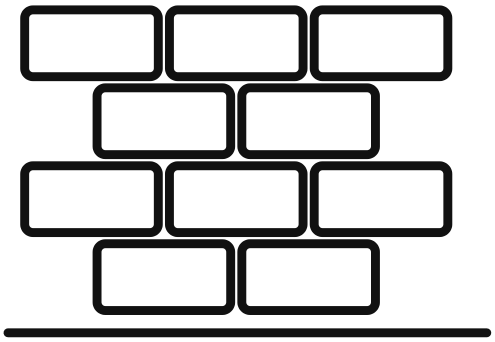
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ee' as in "see" — long

MAITHILI PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ी (ईकार)

क + ी = की



ई IS FOR

ईंटा

eeṇṭaa

brick

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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NAME · नाम

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u

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'u' as in "put" — short

MAITHILI PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ु (उकार)

क + ु = कु



उ IS FOR

उपहार

uphaar

gift

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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NAME · नाम

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oo

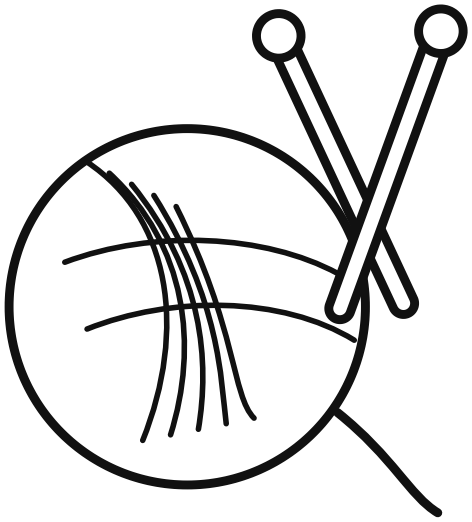
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'oo' as in "moon" — long

MAITHILI PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ू (ऊकार)

क + ू = कू



ऊ IS FOR

ऊन

oon

wool

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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NAME · नाम

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ri

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

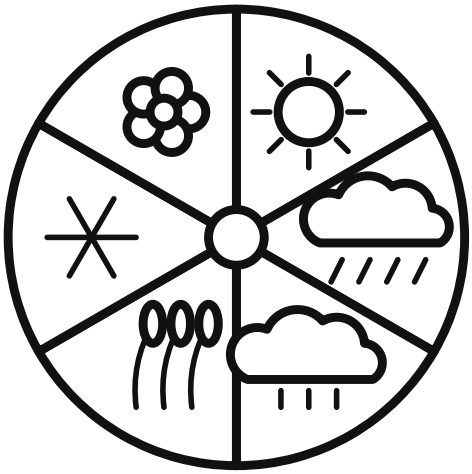
'ri' as in "ring" — a rare letter

MAITHILI PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ृ (ऋकार)

क + ृ = कृ

Rare in Maithili: ऋ is used only in a few words that come from Sanskrit.



ऋ IS FOR

ऋतु

ritu

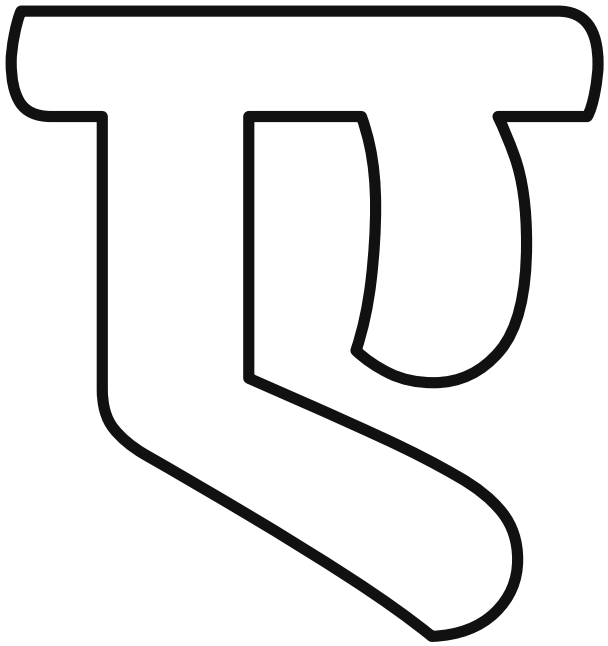
season

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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NAME · नाम

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e

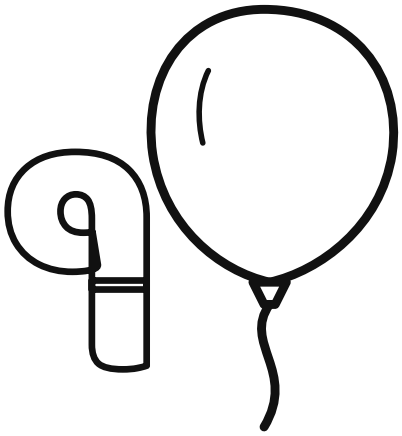
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'e' as in "they" (say "ay")

MAITHILI PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

े (एकार)

क + े = के



ए IS FOR

एक

ek

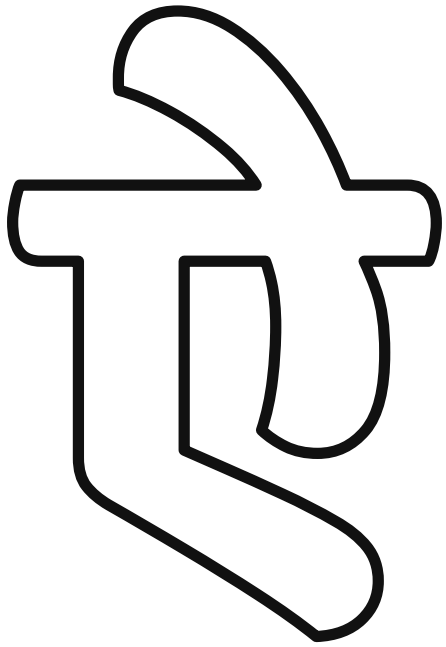
one

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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NAME · नाम

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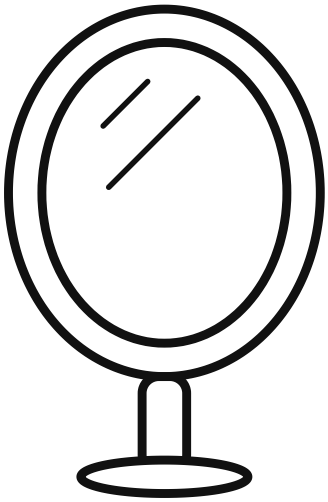
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ai' as in "aisle"

MAITHILI PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ै (ऐकार)

क + ै = कै



ऐ IS FOR

ऐना

ainaa

mirror

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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NAME · नाम

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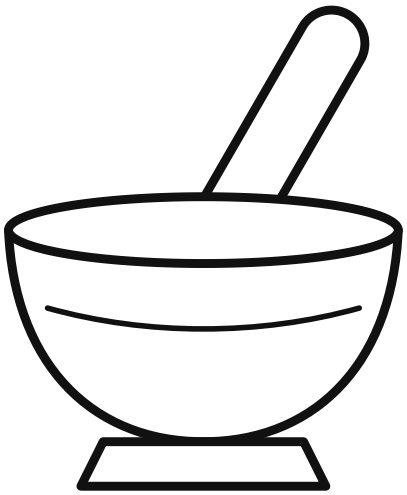
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'o' as in "go"

MAITHILI PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ो (ओकार)

क + ो = को



ओ IS FOR

ओखरि

okhari

mortar (for grinding)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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au

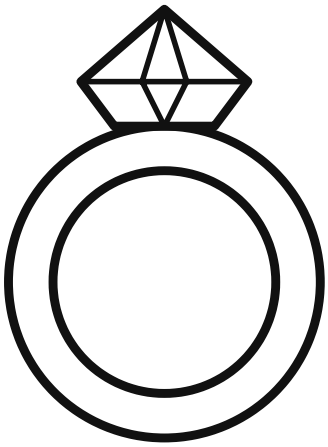
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'au' — like the 'ow' in "owl"

MAITHILI PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ौ (औकार)

क + ौ = कौ



औ IS FOR

औंठी

auṇṭhee

ring

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

औ औ औ औ

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अं

NAME · नाम

अं (अनुस्वार)

an

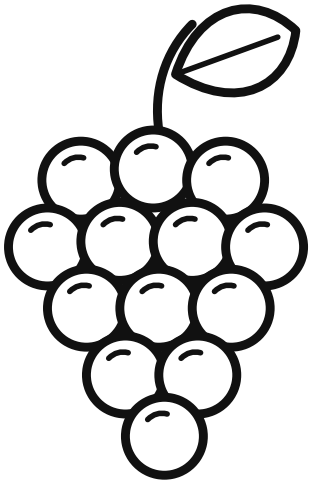
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a nasal ‘n’ or ‘m’ after the vowel

MAITHILI PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ं (अनुस्वार)

क + ं = कं



अं IS FOR

अंगूर

angoor

grapes

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

अं अं अं अं

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अः

NAME · नाम

अः (विसर्ग)

ah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

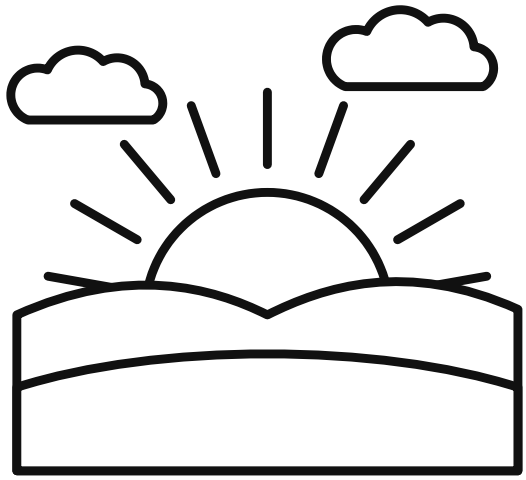
a short breath ‘h’ after the vowel — a rare sign

MAITHILI PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ः (विसर्ग)

क + ः = कः

Rare in Maithili: the sign ः appears only in a few learned words. Everyday Maithili says भोर *bhor* for early morning.



अः IS FOR

प्रातः

praatah

early morning

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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PART 2

The Consonants व्यंजन

vyanjan

Consonants are the sounds made by stopping or squeezing the air: *k, g, ch, j, t, d, p, b*... This book has **38 consonants**. That includes the flapped letters ड़ ढ़ and the joined letters क्ष त्र ज्ञ.

The hidden vowel

Every consonant secretly carries a short vowel *(a)*. That is why क is said *ka*, not just *k*:

क् + अ = क

k + a = ka — the little slanting mark ् (*halant*) means "no vowel".

Families of five

The first consonants come in families, each made in a different part of the mouth:

क ख ग घ ङ — back of the throat

च छ ज झ ञ — middle of the tongue

ट ठ ड ढ ण — tongue curled back (hard)

त थ द ध न — tongue on the teeth (soft)

प फ ब भ म — the lips

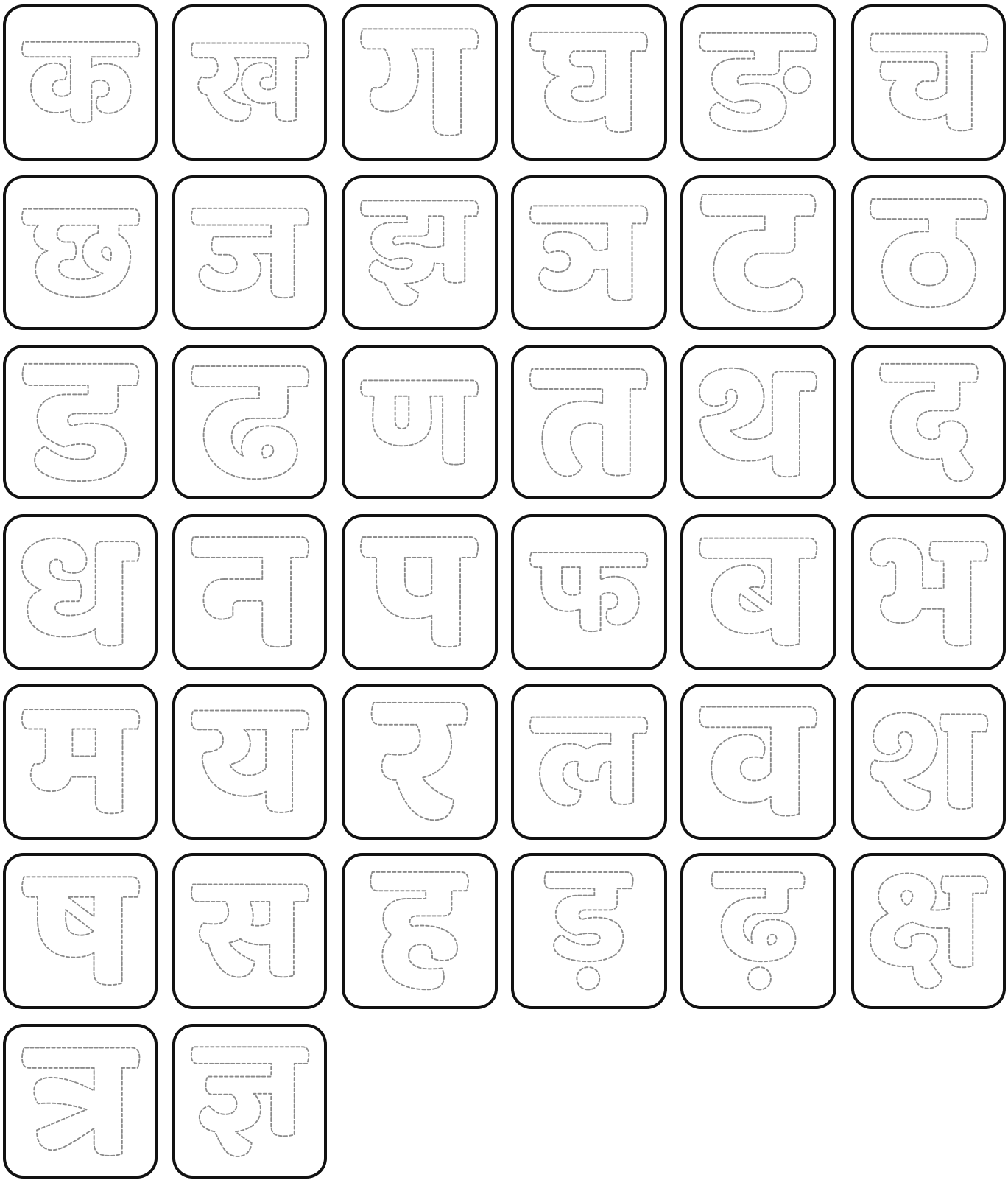
Rare letters

ङ ञ ण ष क्ष ज्ञ are found mostly in words from Sanskrit. In everyday Maithili, श ष स all sound like *s*, ण sounds like न, and व often sounds like ब.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the consonants व्यंजन

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



क

NAME · नाम

क

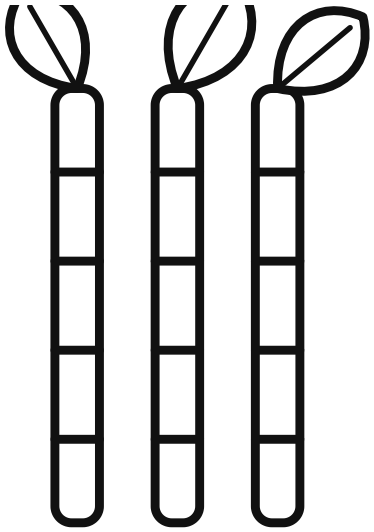
ka

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'k' as in "kite"

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

क् + अ = क



क IS FOR

कुसियार

kusiyaar

sugarcane

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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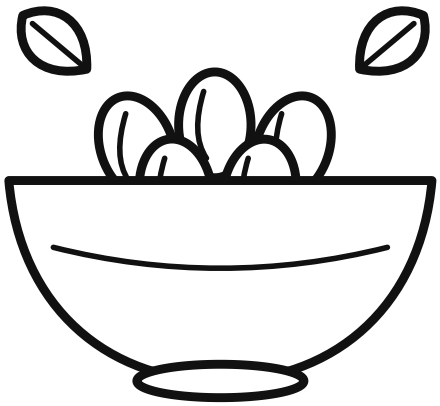
kha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'k' with a puff of air

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ख् + अ = ख



ख IS FOR

खजूर

khajoor

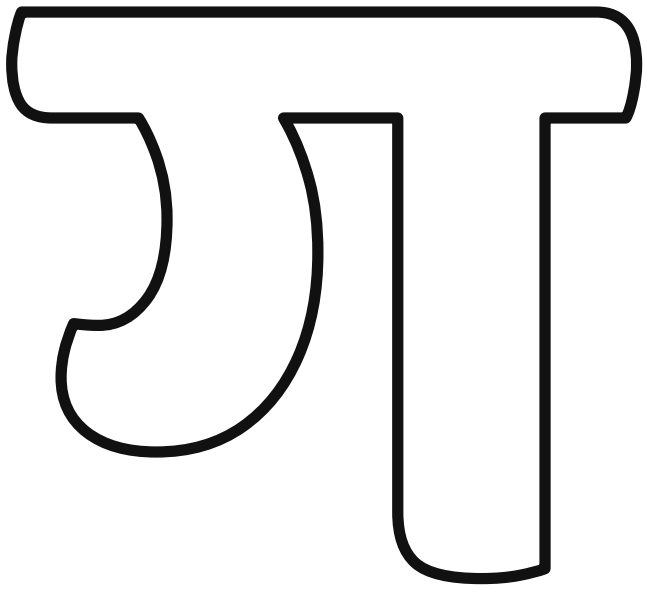
dates

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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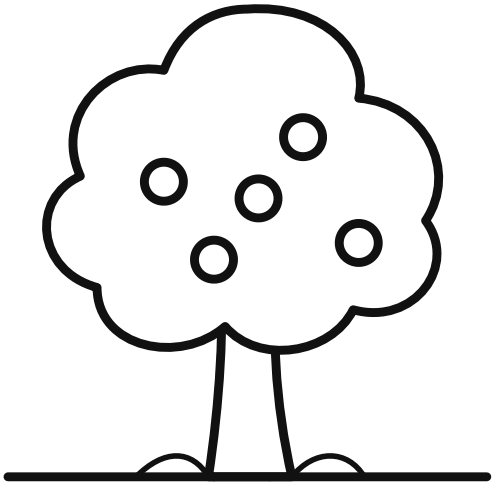
ga

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘g’ as in “go”

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ग् + अ = ग



ग IS FOR

गाछ

gaachh

tree

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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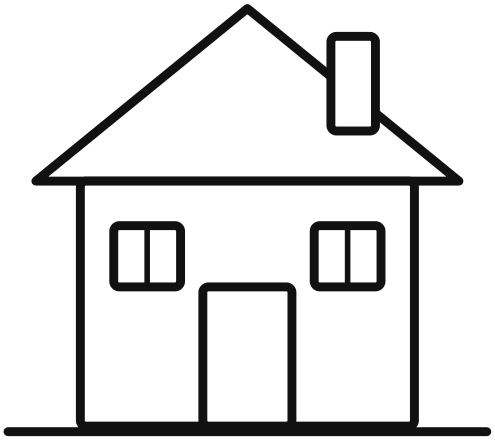
gha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘g’ with a breath

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

घ् + अ = घ



घ IS FOR

घर

ghar

house, home

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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NAME · नाम

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nga

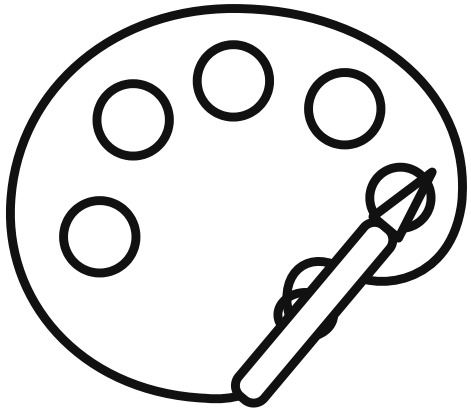
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ng’ as in “sing” — a rare letter

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ङ् + अ = ङ

Today रङ्ग is written रंग, with a dot instead of ङ.



ङ IS FOR

रङ्ग

rang

colour

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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NAME · नाम

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cha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ch' as in "chair"

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

च् + अ = च



च IS FOR

चान

chaan

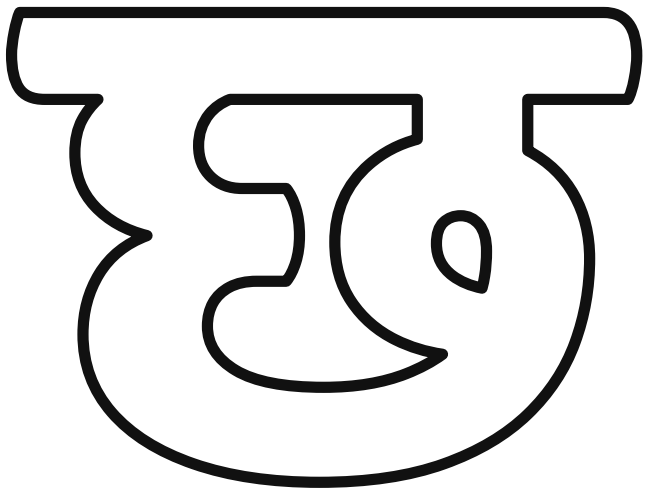
moon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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NAME · नाम

छ

chha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ch' with a puff of air

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

छ् + अ = छ



छ IS FOR

छाता

chhaataa

umbrella

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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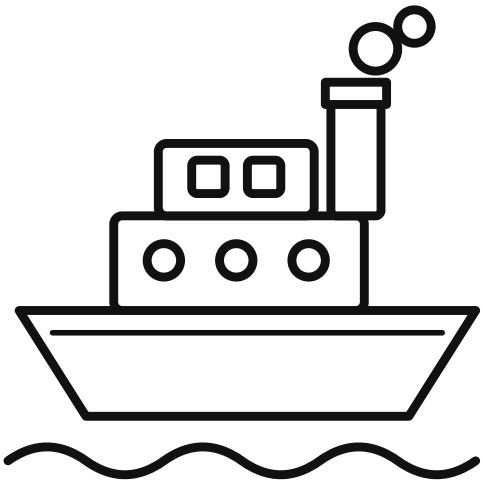
ja

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'j' as in "jam"

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ज् + अ = ज



ज IS FOR

जहाज

jahaaj

ship

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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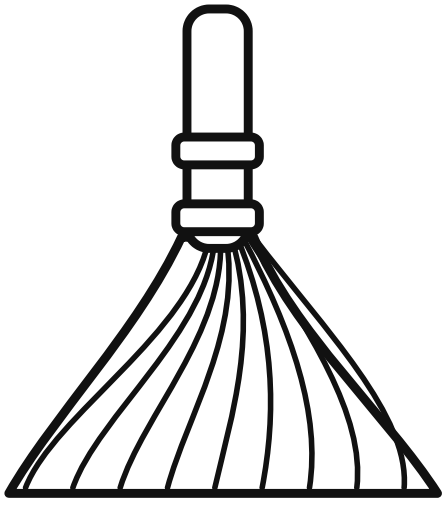
jha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'j' with a breath

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

झ् + अ = झ



झ IS FOR

झाड़ू

jhaaṛoo

broom

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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NAME · नाम

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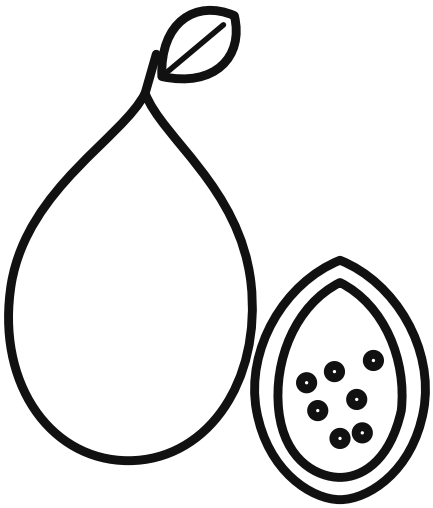
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft ‘n’ near the roof of the mouth — a rare letter

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ञ् + अ = ञ

Today अञ्जीर is written अंजीर.



ञ IS FOR

अञ्जीर

anjeer

fig

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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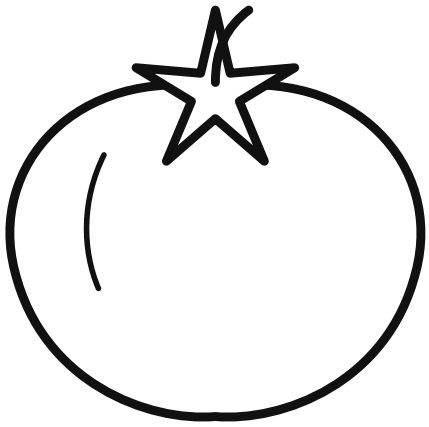
ṭa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a hard ‘t’ — curl your tongue back, as in “top”

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ट् + अ = ट



ट IS FOR

टमाटर

ṭamaaṭar

tomato

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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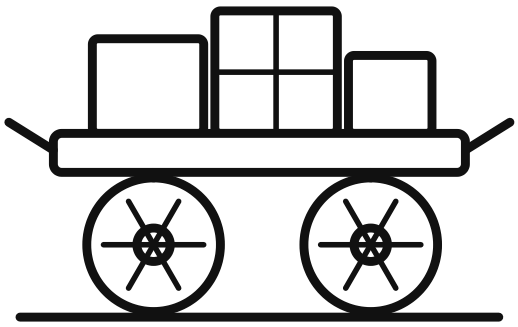
ṭha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a hard ‘t’ with a puff of air

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ठ् + अ = ठ



ठ IS FOR

ठेला

ṭhelaa

push-cart

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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NAME · नाम

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SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a hard ‘d’ — curl your tongue back, as in “dog”

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ड् + अ = ड



ड IS FOR

डाली

ḍaalee

basket

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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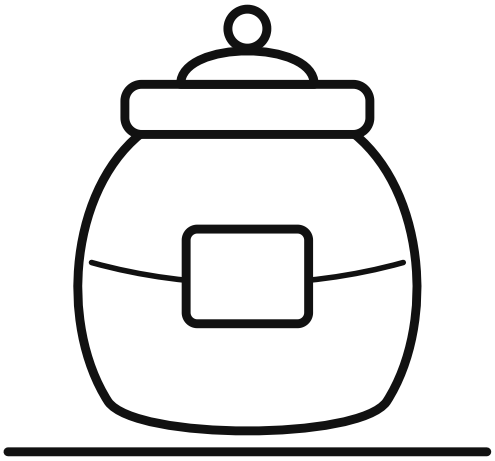
ḍha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a hard ‘d’ with a breath

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ढ् + अ = ढ



ढ IS FOR

ढाकन

ḍhaakan

lid

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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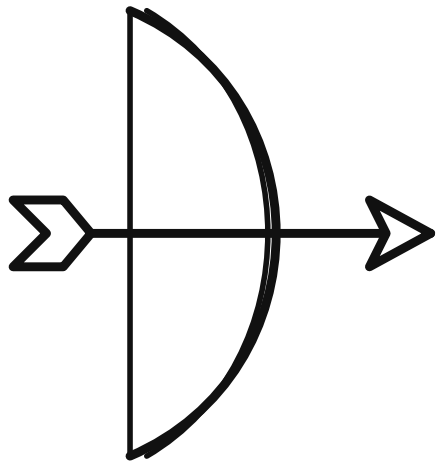
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'n' with the tongue curled back — rare; most Maithili speakers say it like न

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ण् + अ = ण

Look for ण at the end of बाण!



ण IS FOR

बाण

baaṇ

arrow

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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NAME · नाम

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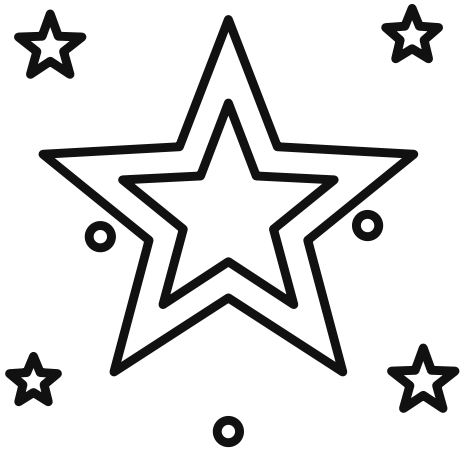
ta

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft ‘t’ — tongue touches the back of the teeth

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

त् + अ = त



त IS FOR

तरेगन

taregan

stars

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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NAME · नाम

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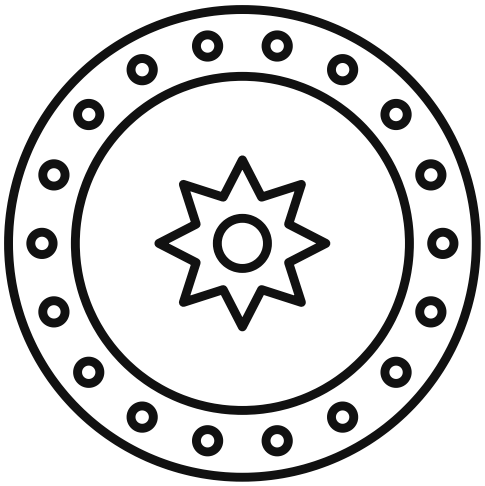
tha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft ‘t’ with a puff of air

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

थ् + अ = थ



थ IS FOR

थारी

thaaree

plate

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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NAME · नाम

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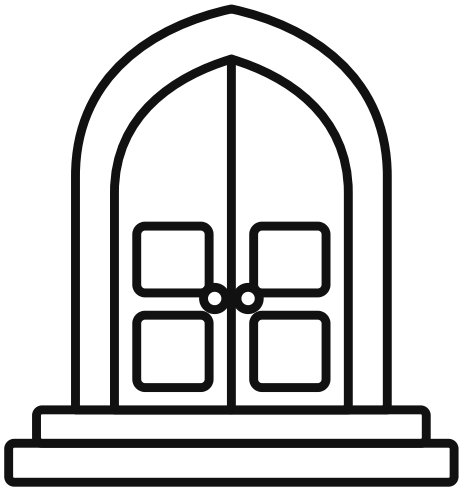
da

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft ‘d’ — tongue touches the back of the teeth

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

द् + अ = द



द IS FOR

दरबज्जा

darbajjaa

door, front porch

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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NAME · नाम

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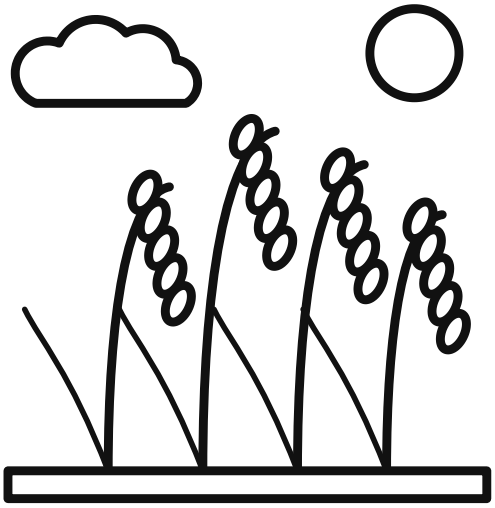
dha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft ‘d’ with a breath

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ध् + अ = ध



ध IS FOR

धान

dhaan

rice plants (paddy)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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NAME · नाम

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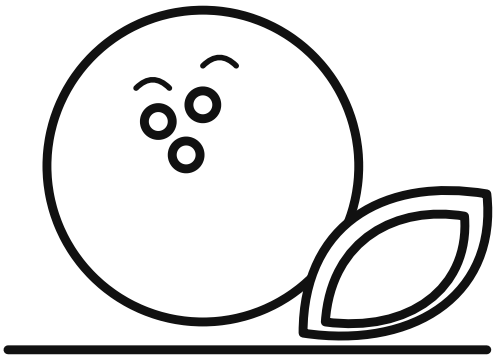
na

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'n' as in "net"

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

न् + अ = न



न IS FOR

नारियर

naariyar

coconut

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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NAME · नाम

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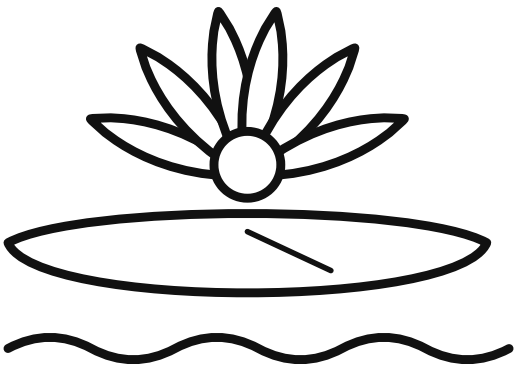
pa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘p’ as in “pen”

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

प् + अ = प



प IS FOR

पोखरि

pokhari

pond (with lotus flowers)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

प प प प

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NAME · नाम

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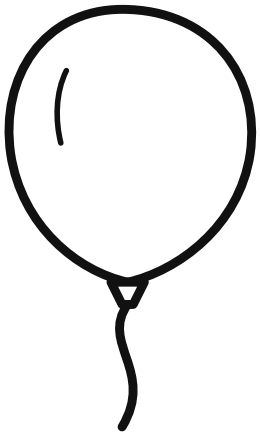
pha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'p' with a puff of air

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

फ् + अ = फ



फ IS FOR

फुकना

phuknaa

balloon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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NAME · नाम

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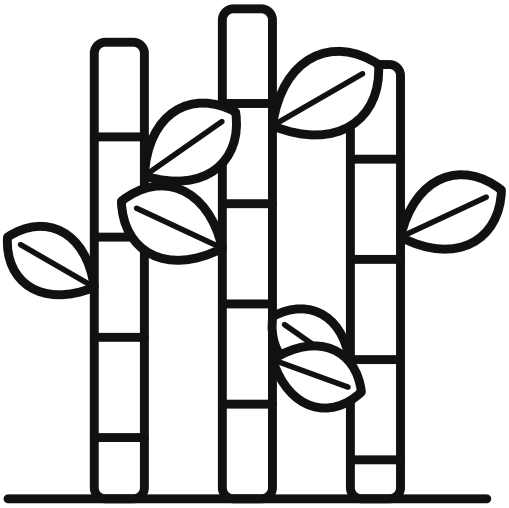
ba

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘b’ as in “ball”

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ब् + अ = ब



ब IS FOR

बाँस

baans

bamboo

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

ब ब ब ब

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भ

NAME · नाम

भ

bha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'b' with a breath

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

भ् + अ = भ



भ IS FOR

भात

bhaat

cooked rice

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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NAME · नाम

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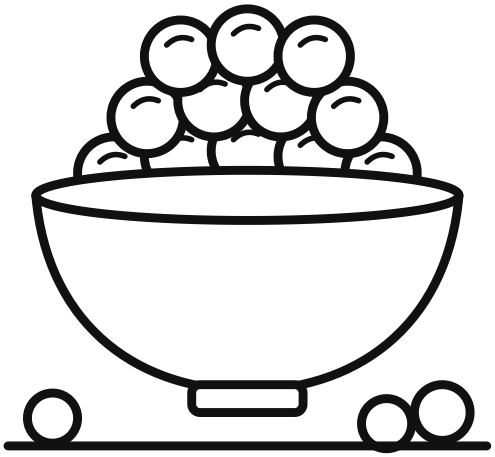
ma

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'm' as in "moon"

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

म् + अ = म



म IS FOR

मखान

makhaan

fox nuts (puffed lotus seeds)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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NAME · नाम

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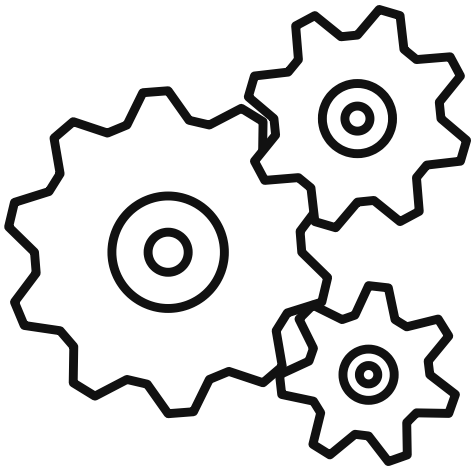
ya

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘y’ as in “yes” — at the start of a word Maithili often says ‘j’

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

य् + अ = य



य IS FOR

यंत्र

yantra

machine

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

य य य य

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र

NAME · नाम

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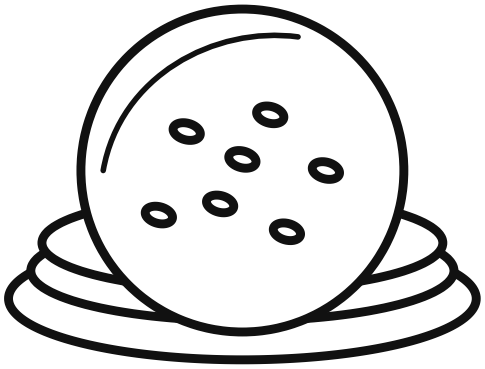
ra

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a tapped ‘r’

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

र् + अ = र



र IS FOR

रोटी

roṭee

flatbread (roti)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

र र र र

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ल

NAME · नाम

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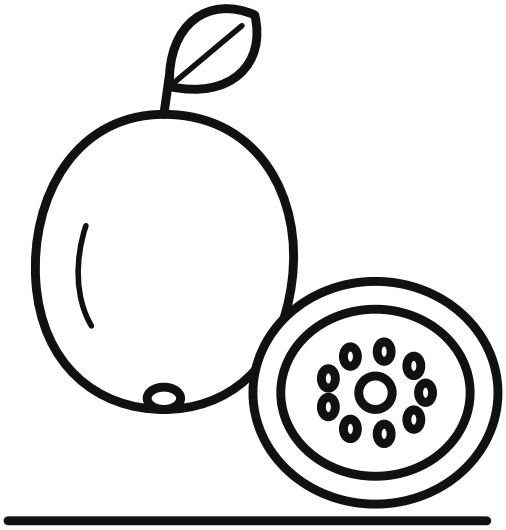
la

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'l' as in "lamp"

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ल् + अ = ल



ल IS FOR

लताम

lataam

guava

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

ल ल ल ल

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व

NAME · नाम

व

va

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

between ‘v’ and ‘w’ — Maithili often says ‘b’

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

व् + अ = व

In everyday Maithili rain is बरखा *barkhaa*.



व IS FOR

वर्षा

varshaa

rain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

व व व व

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श

NAME · नाम

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sha

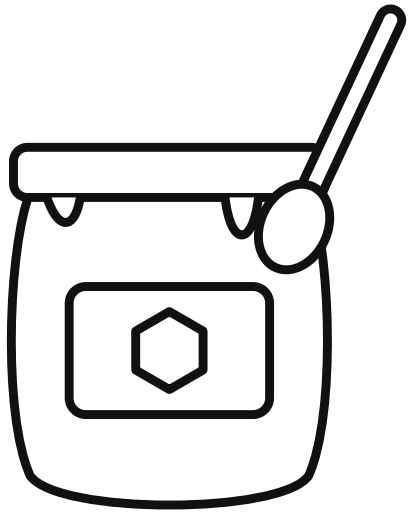
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'sh' as in "shoe" — Maithili usually says 's'

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

श् + अ = श

Maithili more often says मधु *madhu* for honey.



श IS FOR

शहद

shahad

honey

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

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ष

NAME · नाम

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sha

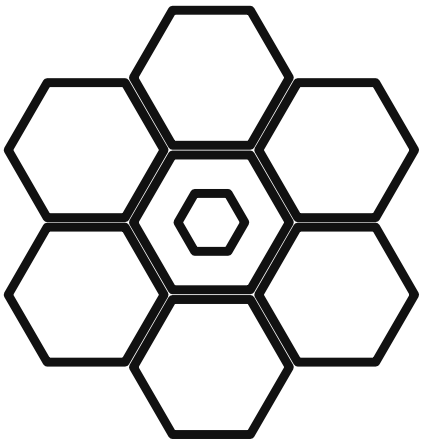
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘sh’ with the tongue curled back — a rare letter

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ष् + अ = ष

ष is found only in words that come from Sanskrit.



ष IS FOR

षट्कोण

shaṭkoṇ

hexagon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

ष ष ष ष

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स

NAME · नाम

स

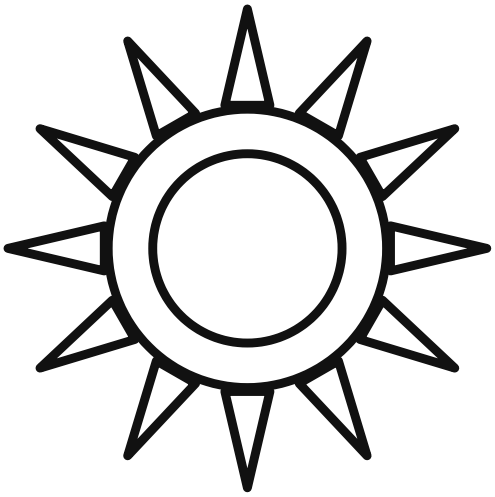
sa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun”

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

स् + अ = स



स IS FOR

सुरुज

suruj

sun

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

स स स स

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ह

NAME · नाम

ह

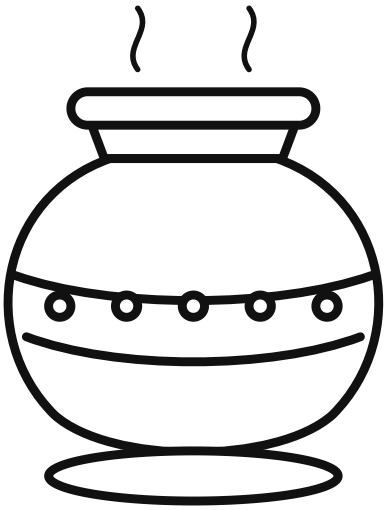
ha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'h' as in "hat"

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ह् + अ = ह



ह IS FOR

हाँड़ी

haaṇ̣ee

clay pot

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

ह ह ह ह

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ड़

NAME · नाम

ड़

ṛa

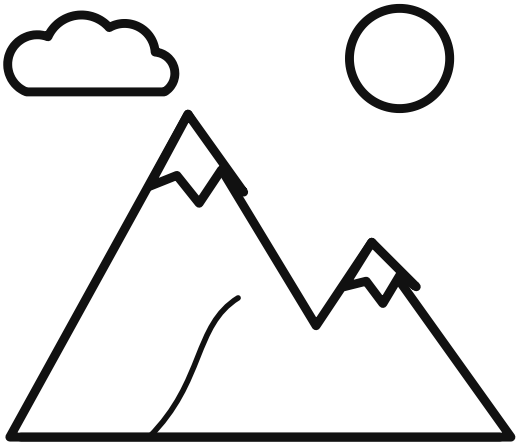
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a quick flapped ‘r’ — never at the start of a word

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ड + ◌़ (dot) = ड़

Look for ड़ at the end of पहाड़!



ड़ IS FOR

पहाड़

pahaaṛ

mountain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

ड़ ड़ ड़ ड़

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ढ़

NAME · नाम

ढ़

ṛha

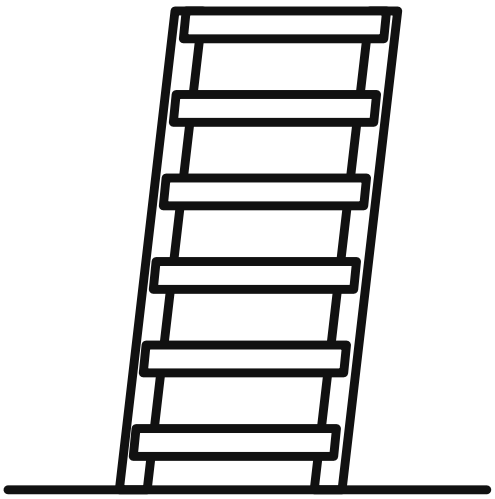
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a flapped ‘r’ with a breath — never at the start of a word

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ढ + ◌़ (dot) = ढ़

Find ढ़ in the middle of सीढ़ी!



ढ़ IS FOR

सीढ़ी

seeṛhee

ladder

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

ढ़ ढ़ ढ़ ढ़

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क्ष

NAME · नाम

क्ष

ksha

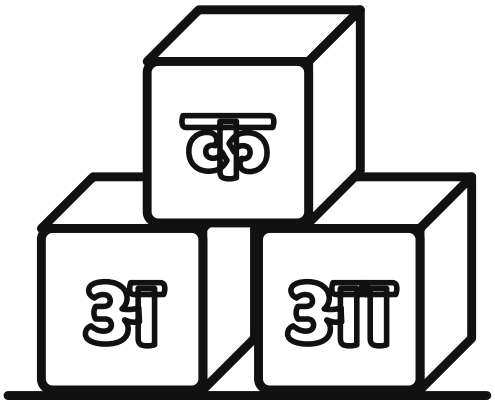
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ + ‘sh’ said together — rare; often said ‘chh’

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

क् + ष = क्ष

Find क्ष in the middle of अक्षर!



क्ष IS FOR

अक्षर

akshar

letter (of the alphabet)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

क्ष क्ष क्ष क्ष

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त्र

NAME · नाम

त्र

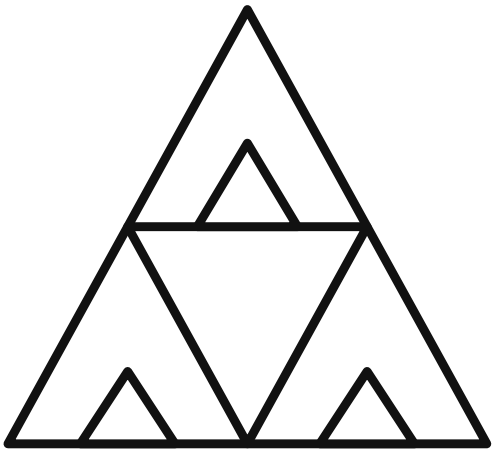
tra

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘t’ + ‘r’ said together

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

त् + र = त्र



त्र IS FOR

त्रिकोण

trikoṇ

triangle

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

त्र त्र त्र त्र

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ज्ञ

NAME · नाम

ज्ञ

gya

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

said ‘gya’ in Maithili — a rare letter

MAITHILI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ज् + ञ = ज्ञ



ज्ञ IS FOR

ज्ञान

gyaan

knowledge

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · लिखू

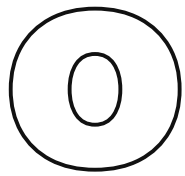
ज्ञ ज्ञ ज्ञ ज्ञ

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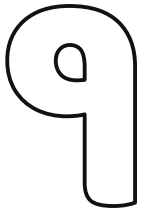
BONUS

Maithili numbers अंक *(ank)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Maithili: *shoonya*, *ek*, *doo*, *teen*...



0
शून्य
shoonya
zero



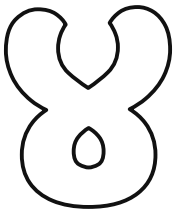
1
एक
ek
one



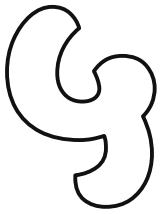
2
दू
doo
two



3
तीन
teen
three



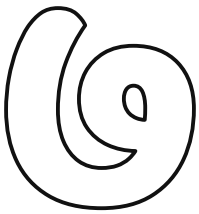
4
चारि
chaari
four



5
पाँच
paanch
five



6
छह
chhah
six



7
सात
saat
seven



8
आठ
aaṭh
eight



9
नौ
nau
nine

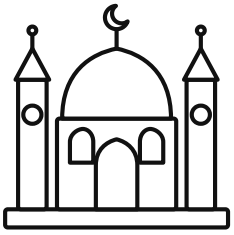
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LET'S TALK

My first Maithili words पहिल शब्द

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

अस्सलामु अलैकुम	*assalaamu alaikum* **Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)**
व अलैकुम अस्सलाम	*va alaikum assalaam* **And upon you be peace (the reply)**
हमर नाम … अछि	*hamar naam … achhi* **My name is …**
धन्यवाद	*dhanyavaad* **Thank you**
जज़ाकल्लाहु ख़ैरन	*jazaakallaahu khairan* **May Allah reward you with good**
माय · बाबू	*maay · baaboo* **Mother · Father**
भाय · बहिन	*bhaay · bahin* **Brother · Sister**
हँ · नहि	*han · nahi* **Yes · No**
हम मैथिली सिखि रहल छी!	*ham maithilee sikhi rahal chhee!* **I am learning Maithili!**







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

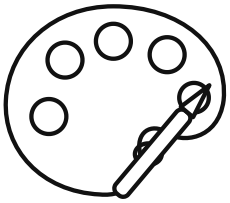
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International), the Census of India 2011 and the National Census of Nepal; the 2003 date from the **Constitution of India** (92nd Amendment).

What's next?
You have met all **51 Maithili letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Maithili, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

माशाअल्लाह! बड़ नीक!

maashaa-allaah! baṛ neek! — Well done, very good!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 51 letters of the Maithili alphabet.

_____ Date

_____ Grown-up's signature

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah — Publisher
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